THE COMMIT BOOK

THE COMMIT BOOK · PLAYBOOK

```
Class of 2029 edition. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.
Edition 2026-27 · Rules checked 2026-11-05 · Education, not legal advice. No outcome promised.
```

Class of 2029 edition. Rules checked 2026-11-05 against the 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual.

> Education, not legal advice. Nothing here promises a scholarship, an offer, a roster spot or playing time. Confirm every date with each school's compliance office. Dates marked `PROJECTED` are calculated from current bylaws and are not yet published by the NCAA. Dates marked `RECOMMENDED` are ours, not NCAA deadlines.

CONTENTS

1. How football recruiting is timed
2. The two academic lines you can't fix late
3. The dated calendar, June 2027 to February 2029
4. Build a target list in three tiers
5. Scripts: first email, follow-up, first call
6. The junior-year official visit window
7. Written offers and signing
8. Trackers (print these)
9. Sources

1. HOW FOOTBALL RECRUITING IS TIMED

Three things open at different times. Don't treat them as one date.

WHAT OPENS	WHEN (CLASS OF 2029)	RULE
Coach calls, texts, emails to your athlete	2027-06-15 (after sophomore year)	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1
Off-campus, in-person contact	2028-01-01 (junior year)	D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.6, 13.1.5.3
Paid (official) visits	2028-04-01 to 2028-06-25, then from Sept 1 of senior year	D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.7, 13.6.3
Written aid offer	On or after 2028-11-15 (senior year)	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.3

Unofficial visits that involve the athletics department are allowed at any age, subject to the recruiting calendar's dead periods.

New for 2027 (FBS only). Bylaw 13.1.5.3 for bowl subdivision football was adopted 10/7/26, effective 1/1/27: a school gets four recruiting opportunities (contacts and evaluations) per prospect from January 1 through May 31, no more than one a week (Monday to Sunday). Of those four, two contacts may be anywhere and two only at the athlete's high school (Bylaw 13.1.5.3.2). A school visit counts as an opportunity for every prospect at that school (Bylaw 13.1.4.3). FCS stays on the older rule: two opportunities per contact period after January 1 of junior year. Limits apply to the whole program, not per coach.

What this means for you: a spring visit from a coach is scarce. Have film, transcript and schedule ready before January 1, 2028.

2. THE TWO ACADEMIC LINES YOU CAN'T FIX LATE

Line 1, the 10/7 lock. D1 requires 10 of the 16 core courses, 7 of them English, math or science, finished before the first day of the seventh semester. Those grades lock. Your high school sets the exact date. (D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b))

Line 2, the finish. 16 core courses with at least a 2.300 core GPA, graduate, and the final transcript sent to the Eligibility Center. Core GPA isn't the transcript GPA. (D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a); course criteria Bylaw 14.3.1.3)

The 16: English 4 years, math 3 (Algebra I or higher), natural/physical science 2, one more English/math/science, social science 2, four more academic courses (Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a)).

Full worksheet: see the companion playbook *Eligibility: the 2 Hard Deadlines*.

3. THE DATED CALENDAR

DATE	TYPE	WHAT TO DO	RULE
2026-11-15	RECOMMENDED	Counselor checks every planned course against your school's NCAA list	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1
2027-06-15	OPENING	Coaches may call, text, email. Send your first emails now	D1 Bylaws 13.1.3.1, 13.4.1
2027-08-15	RECOMMENDED	Open the Eligibility Center certification account ($110 domestic, waivers possible). Needed before any D1 official visit	D1 Bylaw 13.6.3
Fall 2027	YOUR PLAN	Junior film cut by mid-season; update target list	—
2028-01-01	OPENING	Off-campus contact begins. FBS: 4 opportunities Jan 1 to May 31	D1 Bylaws 13.1.1.1.6, 13.1.5.3
2028-04-01 to 06-25	WINDOW	Junior-year official visits. Each needs transcript, EC account, spot on the school's list	D1 Bylaws 13.6.2.1.7, 13.6.3
Before 7th semester (school sets)	HARD	10/7 core courses complete	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(b)
2028-11-15	OPENING	Written aid offers may arrive. Verbal offers bind no one	D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.3
2028-11-29 to 12-01	PROJECTED	Early signing period	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(c)
2029-02-07	PROJECTED	Regular signing opens; each school sets its own final date	D1 Bylaw 13.02.13.1(e)
2029-04-01	WINDOW	Request final amateurism certification	Eligibility Center procedure
Graduation	HARD	16 cores, 2.300 core GPA, final transcript sent	D1 Bylaw 14.3.1.1(a)

Exception to know: in August of senior year, FBS/FCS schools may host a paid visit 48 hours either side of a home game (Bylaw 13.6.2.1.7.1).

4. TARGET LIST IN THREE TIERS

Aim for 30 to 50 programs across levels. Fill one row each.

TIER	WHAT IT MEANS	HOW MANY
Reach	Level you'd love; you need a coach to say you fit	8 to 12
Fit	Level where your film, size and grades match recent rosters (you check the roster pages)	15 to 25
Sure	Programs where you'd likely play and the school fits academically. Include D2, D3, NAIA, JUCO	8 to 12

For each: division, position need (count seniors at your position on the roster), position coach name and staff email from the official staff page, school's academic fit, cost after likely aid (D3 = no athletic aid).

5. SCRIPTS

First email (athlete sends, after 2027-06-15). Subject: `2029 [Position] | [Height/Weight] | [HS], [City, ST] | Film`

> Coach [Last name], I'm [Name], a Class of 2029 [position] at [HS] in [City, ST]. [Height], [weight]; [one verified stat or measurable with source/date]. My junior film is here: [link]. GPA [x.x]; core courses on track. I'd like to learn what you look for at [position] and whether I should attend your camp. Schedule: [link]. Head coach: [name, phone, email]. Thank you, [Name], [phone].

Follow-up (14 days, no reply).

> Coach [Last name], following up with new film from [game, date]: [link]. Still very interested in [School]. [Name]

First call checklist (athlete leads, parent listens). Ask: Where do I fit on your board at my position? How many [position]s are you taking in 2029? What would you need to see from me next? What's the academic profile of your signees? When do you hold junior days and camps?

Don't ask a coach for an offer on a first call. Write down exactly what was said and when.

6. THE JUNIOR-YEAR OFFICIAL VISIT WINDOW (2028-04-01 TO 06-25)

Before the visit: EC certification account open; transcript sent to the school; you're on their visit list (D1 Bylaw 13.6.3). Visit checklist: meet the academic advisor; ask how many players at your position are returning; ask for the aid terms in writing (they can't write an aid offer until 2028-11-15); score the visit the same night (tracker below).

7. WRITTEN OFFERS AND SIGNING

- A verbal "offer" is not binding on you or the school.
- Written aid offers can't come before 2028-11-15 of senior year; you can't sign the acceptance until the signing period (D1 Bylaw 13.9.3.3, 13.02.13.1).
- Signing ends other schools' recruiting of you. Read the offer sheet in the *Offers & Signing Day* playbook before signing.
- Ask compliance: is this aid for one year or multiple? What happens if the head coach leaves? What settlement-related benefits, if any, are in writing?

8. TRACKERS

Contact log

DATE	SCHOOL	COACH	HOW (EMAIL/CALL/VISIT)	WHAT WAS SAID	NEXT STEP	FOLLOW-UP DATE

Visit score (1-5 each)

SCHOOL	POSITION FIT	ACADEMICS	COACHES	PLAYERS	COST AFTER AID	TOTAL

Monthly checklist

- [ ] New film posted - [ ] 5 new emails sent - [ ] Follow-ups due sent - [ ] Grades checked against core plan - [ ] Calendar dead periods checked for any planned visit

9. SOURCES

- 2026-27 NCAA Division I Manual (LSDBi report 90008): https://web3.ncaa.org/lsdbi/reports/getReport/90008 — checked 2026-11-05 (printing dated 11/5/26). Bylaws 13.1.1.1.6, 13.1.3.1, 13.1.4.3, 13.1.5.3 (FBS, adopted 10/7/26 eff. 1/1/27), 13.1.5.3.2, 13.4.1, 13.6.2.1.7, 13.6.2.1.7.1, 13.6.3, 13.9.3.3, 13.02.13.1, 14.3.1.1, 14.3.1.3.
- Eligibility Center registration checklist: https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/Registration_Checklist.pdf
- Final amateurism certification: https://fs.ncaa.org/Docs/eligibility_center/Student_Resources/How_to_Request_Final_Amateurism_Certification.pdf